

Status Epilepticus



Section I: Scenario Demographics

Scenario Title:	Status Epilepticus
Date of Development:	29/02/2016 (DD/MM/YYYY)
Target Learning Group:	☐ Juniors (PGY 1 – 2) ☒ Seniors (PGY ≥ 3) ☐ All Groups

Section II: Scenario Developers

Scenario Developer(s):	Donika Orlich (Adapted from Hyponatremic Seizure case by Kyla Caners)
Affiliations/Institution(s):	McMaster University
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Section III: Curriculum Integration

Learning Goals & Objectives	
Educational Goal:	To expose learners to a patient with refractory status epilepticus.
CRM Objectives:	1) Demonstrate clear communication with team members, defining order of tasks and listening to team input 2) Demonstrates problem solving by displaying an organized and efficient approach to the clinical scenario along with concurrent management 3) Demonstrates appropriate debriefing in the context of medication error
Medical Objectives:	1) Considers a broad DDx of status epilepticus and initiates appropriate work-up and initial management 2) Employs appropriate medical therapy for refractory status including consideration of antidotes for rare, yet reversible, causes 3) Initiates appropriate post-intubation care including imaging, ICU consult and continuous EEG monitoring

Case Summary: Brief Summary of Case Progression and Major Events

38F presents actively seizing with EMS. She will fail to respond to repeat doses of IV benzo's, and will require escalating medial management. Following Dilantin infusion, the patient will become hypotensive (because the Dilantin was given as a "push dose", which the nurse will mention). The patient will then stop her GTC seizure, but will remain unresponsive with eye deviation. The team should recognize this as subclinical status, and proceed to intubate the patient. The patient will continue to seize following phenobarbital and propofol infusion. Urgent consults to radiology and ICU should be made to expedite care out of the ED. The team will be expected to debrief the Dilantin medication error and disclose the error to the husband.

References

Marx, J. A., Hockberger, R. S., Walls, R. M., & Adams, J. (2013). *Rosen's emergency medicine: Concepts and clinical practice*. St. Louis: Mosby.



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Section IV: Scenario Script

A. Scenario Cast & Realism			
Patient:	☒ Computerized Mannequin	Realism:	☒ Conceptual
	☐ Mannequin		☐ Physical
	☐ Standardized Patient		☒ Emotional/Experiential
	☐ Hybrid		☐ Other:
	☐ Task Trainer		☐ N/A
Confederates		Brief Description of Role	
Husband		Will provide extra information on HPI, ROS, PMx and Meds for patient.	
Nurse		Will cue team to seizures and remind them repeatedly that patient is still seizing. Also admits to medication error after 3 rd dilantin is given "IV push".	
B. Required Monitors			
☒ EKG Leads/Wires	☐ Temperature Probe	☐ Central Venous Line	
☒ NIBP Cuff	☐ Defibrillator Pads	☐ Capnography	
☒ Pulse Oximeter	☐ Arterial Line	☐ Other:	
C. Required Equipment			
☒ Gloves	☒ Nasal Prongs	☐ Scalpel	
☒ Stethoscope	☒ Venturi Mask	☐ Tube Thoracostomy Kit	
☐ Defibrillator	☒ Non-Rebreather Mask	☐ Cricothyroidotomy Kit	
☒ IV Bags/Lines	☒ Bag Valve Mask	☐ Thoracotomy Kit	
☒ IV Push Medications	☒ Laryngoscope	☐ Central Line Kit	
☐ PO Tabs	☐ Video Assisted Laryngoscope	☐ Arterial Line Kit	
☐ Blood Products	☒ ET Tubes	☐ Other:	
☐ Intraosseous Set-up	☐ LMA	☐ Other:	
D. Moulage			
None required.			
E. Approximate Timing			
Set-Up:	3 min	Scenario:	15 min
		Debriefing:	15 min

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Section V: Patient Data and Baseline State

A. Clinical Vignette: To Read Aloud at Beginning of Case

Annie Jones is a 38 F brought in by EMS with active seizure. She was last seen normal about 45 minutes ago by husband, and has been witnessed seizing now for about 20 minutes. She is known to have epilepsy. EMS have 1 line in place, and have given 5mg IV midazolam en route.

OTHER HX if EMS Asked:

Vitals: HR 140, BP 130/80, RR 12, O2 99% on NRB, Glucose 6.5

PMHx: Epilepsy, hypothyroid, depression

Meds: List given

ROS: Husband states well prior to today. Has been having more nocturnal seizures since meds changed

B. Patient Profile and History

Patient Name: Annie Jones

Age: 38

Weight: 50kg

Gender: ☐ M ☒ F

Code Status: Full

Chief Complaint: Seizure

History of Presenting Illness: Seizure meds changed 1 month ago. Since then, her nocturnal seizures have been more frequent. Today husband found her seizing and she hasn't stopped since.

Past Medical History:

Epilepsy

Hypothyroidism

Depression

Medications:

Topiramate 200 BID

Vimpat 100 BID

Levothyroxine 125mcg daily

Celexa 20mg daily

Allergies: Sulfa

Social History: **Lives with husband.** Non-smoker. No EtOH.

Review of Systems:

CNS:

Nocturnal seizures for 1/12 since meds changed.

HEENT:

Nil. No recent HI/trauma

CVS:

No CP, no palpitations.

RESP:

No SOB.

GI:

Nil

GU:

No UTI symptoms.

MSK:

Nil

INT:

No fevers

C. Baseline Simulator State and Physical Exam

☐ No Monitor Display

☒ Monitor On, no data displayed

☐ Monitor on Standard Display

HR: 130/min

BP: 130/80

RR: 12/min

O₂SAT: 96% NRB

Rhythm: NSR

T: 36.4°C

Glucose: 6.4 mmol/L

GCS: 3 (seizing only)

General Status: **Ongoing seizure.**

CNS:

Ongoing seizure.

HEENT:

No signs HI. Pupils 3mm, non-reactive.

CVS:

No murmur.

RESP:

GAEB, no advent.

ABDO:

Soft, NT.

GU:

Nil.

MSK:

No signs trauma.

SKIN:

Nil.



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Section VI: Scenario Progression

Scenario States, Modifiers and Triggers			
Patient State	Patient Status	Learner Actions, Modifiers & Triggers to Move to Next State	
1. Seizure Rhythm: NSR HR: 130/min BP: 130/80 RR: 12/min O ₂ SAT: 96% NRB T: 36.4°C	Generalized tonic clonic seizure.	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ IV access, monitors, bolus ☐ LLD position, suctioning ☐ Cap sugar: 6.4 ☐ Blood work: tox, lytes, extended lytes, TSH, ASA, Tylenol ☐ Urine BHCG ☐ Administer benzo x2 doses ☐ Obtain collateral hx from husband	<u>Modifiers</u> <i>Changes to patient condition based on learner action</i> - 1L NS → BP 140/80 - 2 doses benzos → no change <u>Triggers</u> <i>For progression to next state</i> - 4 min or 2 doses benzo → 2. Benzo-Refractory Seizure
2. Benzo-Refractory Seizure HR → 140 BP → 155/95 O ₂ SAT → 94%	Ongoing GTC seizure.	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Start 2 nd iv line (if not done) ☐ Start 2 nd line agent → Phenytoin load (15-20mg/kg or 1g IV over 30 mins) ☐ Prepare for intubation	<u>Modifiers</u> - Benzo given → ongoing seizure <u>Triggers</u> - Dilantin given → 3. BP drop - Intubation → 5. Refractory status
3. BP drop HR → 140 BP → 80/50 O ₂ SAT → slowly decrease to 90%	Nurse asks whether BP drop could be due to "push dose Dilantin"?	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Start 2 nd iv line (if not done) ☐ IV NS bolus	<u>Modifiers</u> - IV NS 1L bolus → BP 90/60 <u>Triggers</u> - 6 min or NS bolus given → 4. Subclinical Status
4. Subclinical Status HR → 140 BP → 100/70 O ₂ SAT → 90%	GTC seizure stops. Eye deviation to L. Pupils non reactive. Mouth twitching.	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Intubation (propofol + paralytic) ☐ Start 3 rd line agent → Phenobarb (15-20mg/kg) ☐ Request continuous EEG monitor from ICU ☐ ECG	<u>Modifiers</u> - No agent will stop seizure (no pupillary response if intubated) <u>Triggers</u> - Intubation → 5. Refractory Status
5. Refractory Status HR → 139 BP → 120/85 O ₂ → 99% (vented) RR → 12 (vented)	Intubated. No pupillary response.	<u>Learner Actions</u> ☐ Give 2 nd and 3 rd line agents (if not yet done) ☐ Consider empirics (pyridoxine + 3% NS + MgSO ₄ if pregnancy a consideration) ☐ Consider antibiotics, antivirals ☐ Propofol infusion ☐ ICU consult and Neuro consult ☐ Anesthesia consult (for inhalational anesthesia) ☐ Arrange for CT Head ☐ Debrief team re: med error ☐ Disclose error to husband	<u>Modifiers</u> - No agents will stop seizure <u>Triggers</u> - Empirics + propofol infusion or 15 minutes → END CASE

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Section VII: Supporting Documents, Laboratory Results, & Multimedia

Laboratory Results

None

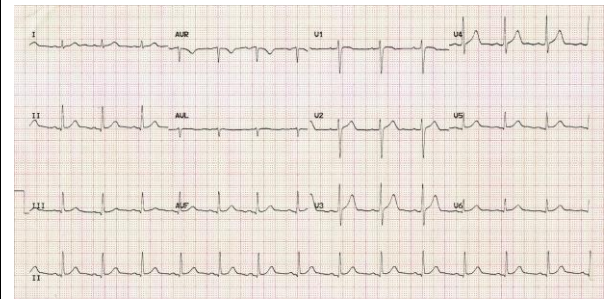
Images (ECGs, CXRs, etc.)

Post-Intubation CXR



(CXR source:
<https://emcow.files.wordpress.com/2012/11/normal-intubation2.jpg>)

ECG showing NSR



(ECG source:
<http://i0.wp.com/lifeinthefastlane.com/wp-content/uploads/2011/12/normal-sinus-rhythm.jpg>)

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Section VIII: Debriefing Guide

General Debriefing Plan	
☐ Individual	☒ Group
☐ With Video	☒ Without Video
Objectives	
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Sample Questions for Debriefing	
1) What was your initial DDx for this patient presenting with seizure? 2) Explain your choice of intubation drugs? Is there any benefit to succ over roc in the seizing patient? 3) When did you realize that the patient might still be seizing despite lack of general tonic-clonic seizure movement? What are indications for continuous EEG monitoring? 4) When should empirics be given to the seizing patient? What do "empirics" include? 5) What causes the drop in BP when phenytoin is given too quickly?	
Key Moments	
1) Initial Broad work-up for likely status epilepticus	
2) Management of refractory status epilepticus	
3) Acknowledgement of medication error leading to debrief of team afterwards and recognition of need to disclose error to husband	